THE WHOLE STORY · SMALL GROUP GUIDE · LESSON 2 OF 26

The God Who Is There

Genesis 1:1 · Exodus 3:14 · Psalm 19 · Isaiah 6

> **The big idea:** Before the beginning, there was God. He needs nothing, he is holy beyond measure, he is one God in three persons, and he has made himself known in his Word and finally in Jesus.

Before you meet: Read

Exodus 3:1–15 | Acts 17:24–25 | Psalm 19 | Isaiah 6:1–7 | John 1:1–18

Open (5 minutes)

When you were a child, what picture came to mind when someone mentioned God? Where do you think that picture came from?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

"He looked, and behold, the bush was burning, yet it was not _____." *(Exodus 3:2)*

"Nor is he served by human hands, as though he _____ anything, since he himself gives to all mankind life and _____ and everything." *(Acts 17:25)*

"The heavens declare the _____ of God, and the sky above proclaims his _____." *(Psalm 19:1)*

"Woe is me! For I am _____ … for my eyes have seen the _____, the LORD of hosts!" *(Isaiah 6:5)*

"Behold, this has touched your lips; your _____ is taken away, and your sin _____ for." *(Isaiah 6:7)*

Jesus told his followers to baptize "in the _____ of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit." *(Matthew 28:19)*

Discuss

1. A child asks you who made God. How would you have answered before this lesson? How would you answer now? *Genesis 1:1; Psalm 90:2*

2. God does not need anything from us. Why might that be good news and not cold news? *Acts 17:24–25*

3. Psalm 19 shows God speaking through the sky and through his Word. What can the stars tell you about God? What can they never tell you? *Psalm 19:1–4, 7–11*

4. Isaiah saw God's holiness and cried, "Woe is me!" Why did seeing God clearly make him see himself clearly? What did God do about it? *Isaiah 6:1–7*

5. In your own words, why is God not one person wearing three masks, and not three gods? How does the scene at the Jordan help? *Deuteronomy 6:4; Matthew 3:16–17*

6. Jesus said, "Whoever has seen me has seen the Father." What is one thing Jesus did in the Gospels that shows you what God is like? *John 1:18; 14:9*

Apply this week

Spend five minutes outside one night this week looking at the sky, and read Psalm 19:1–6 out loud while you do. Then write down one way you have pictured God as smaller or needier than he is, and find one verse from this lesson that corrects it.

Memory verse

"God said to Moses, "I AM WHO I AM.""

Exodus 3:14

Pray

Thank God that he is, that he needs nothing, and that he has still chosen to make himself known. Confess where you have pictured him as small. Ask him to show you his glory in the face of Jesus.

LEADER NOTES · LESSON 2

The God Who Is There

Session plan (about 70 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read Exodus 3:1–15 and Isaiah 6:1–7 aloud together. Read Psalm 19 if time allows.
10 min	Observe: work through the fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
30 min	Discuss: choose 4 of the 6 questions. Questions 2, 4, and 6 matter most.
5 min	Walk the group through WSC 4 (What is God?) and the Shield of the Trinity in the full lesson.
10 min	Apply and pray. Introduce the memory verse and the reading for Lesson 3 (Genesis 1–2; Psalm 8).

Main points to land

1. Nobody made God. He is eternal and needs nothing, and everything else has life from him (Psalm 90:2; Acts 17:24–25). His name, I AM, says that he simply is (Exodus 3:14).
2. God shows himself in two ways. The sky shows his power to everyone (Psalm 19:1; Romans 1:20). Only his Word tells us his name and the way of salvation (Psalm 19:7; WCF 1.1).
3. God is holy beyond measure. Seeing him undoes us, and he himself provides the atonement (Isaiah 6:5–7). His mercy and his justice meet at the cross (Exodus 34:6–7).
4. There is one God in three persons, the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit, the same in substance, equal in power and glory (Deuteronomy 6:4; Matthew 3:16–17; 28:19; WSC 6).
5. God made the world out of his own fullness, so we come to him with empty hands. Jesus is God making himself known (John 1:18; 14:9), and he will never cast out anyone who comes to him (John 6:37).

Answer key (Observe)

1. consumed
2. needed; breath
3. glory; handiwork
4. lost; King
5. guilt; atoned
6. name

Questions people will ask

Then who made God?

Nobody. Everything that has a beginning needs a cause, and God has no beginning: “from everlasting to everlasting you are God” (Psalm 90:2). The question pictures God as one more thing inside the universe. He is the one who made it.

How can God be three and one? Isn't that a contradiction?

It would be if God were one and three in the same sense. He is one in being and three in persons: one What, three Whos. Most comparisons (water, ice, and steam; an egg) end up teaching one of the two errors on the Shield. Say what Scripture says and then bow. A God we could fully figure out would be about our size.

What about people who never hear the Bible?

Creation shows everyone enough of God to leave them "without excuse" (Romans 1:20), but it cannot save (WCF 1.1). That is why God spoke, and why the church sends the gospel to the nations. God is just and will judge rightly. Keep the group from speculating, and turn to the urgency of making Christ known.

Did Jesus really claim to be God?

Yes. He told the religious leaders, "before Abraham was, I am" (John 8:58), taking the name from the burning bush, and they picked up stones to kill him. They understood exactly what he meant. He also said that whoever had seen him had seen the Father (John 14:9).

Closing prayer

Holy, eternal Father, you needed nothing, and yet you have spoken and shown us your name. Thank you for your Son, who has made you known, and for your Spirit, who opens blind eyes. Make each of us small in our own sight and you great, and bring every person in this group to know you through Jesus Christ, who took away our guilt. Amen.